

Cārvāka / Lokāyata — Premium Solved-PYQ and Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional · Paper I · Section B · Indian Philosophy · Syllabus item 12 · 2026 Edition

Companion to: Cārvāka / Lokāyata — Theory of Knowledge and Rejection of Transcendent Entities — Complete Learning Session (10 August 2026)

Evidence key: ✓ canonical doctrine grounded in the authored knowledge file or a local OCR-searchable source ·
 ▲ analytical synthesis for exam use · ? contested or transmitted only through hostile doxography.

How to use this workbook

1. Read the demand decoding table, close the model answer, and write to time.
2. Compare your script against the "What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain" block, not merely against the conclusion.
3. Attempt every MCQ before reading the explanation. The key rotates strictly $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$, repeated eight times across the 32 questions.
4. In every Mains answer, preserve the philosophical sequence: state the thesis $\rightarrow$ reconstruct as numbered premises $\rightarrow$ expose a presupposition $\rightarrow$ objection $\rightarrow$ reply $\rightarrow$ graded verdict with a named criterion.
5. Never conflate the four things a Cārvāka answer may be attacking: formal validity, the grounding of the universal premise, the ontological entities that premise supports, and the ethical consequences drawn from their removal.
6. Carry one source-caution sentence into every answer. The Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost, and every famous Cārvāka line comes to us through an opponent.

Note on exam stage. Philosophy is a Mains-only Optional. It has no Prelims paper and no objective component, so no Prelims PYQs are included or required. Part I therefore contains the complete set of verified Mains PYQs primary-owned by this syllabus item; the MCQs in Parts II and III are original diagnostic instruments, not past objective questions.

Part I — All 9 Verified Topic-Owned PYQs (2018–2025)

Corpus note: ✓ The audited Paper I corpus for 2018–2025 contains 9 primary-owned question-parts for Cārvāka, out of 112 parts overall. The corpus is continuous across all eight years; Cārvāka has no primary-owned part only in 2022 and 2023. The 2022 Q7(c) question on the Naiyāyika response to Cārvāka's objections against anumāna is primary-owned by Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika and is therefore treated in the learning session (Subtopic 4) rather than duplicated here.

#	Year	Q	Marks	Theme
1	2018	Q8(b)	15	Rejection of inference and the other systems
2	2019	Q5(c)	10	Consistency of rejecting inference
3	2019	Q6(c)	15	The Socrates syllogism
4	2020	Q6(b)	15	Rejection of ākāśa; criticism of transmigration
5	2020	Q7(c)	15	Cārvāka versus Jaina conception of Reality

#	Year	Q	Marks	Theme
6	2021	Q5(e)	10	Epistemology and the rejection of transcendental entities
7	2024	Q5(a)	10	Is Cārvāka's philosophy positivistic?
8	2024	Q6(a)	20	Cārvāka's refutation of self versus Buddhist rejection of ātmā
9	2025	Q5(a)	10	The ground for rejecting inference

△ Pattern. Five of the nine parts concern inference. Mastery of the three-door argument, upādhi and the self-refutation exchange therefore covers the majority of the historical demand.

PYQ 1 — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? — a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? — the reasons, school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? — the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point — that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal — survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	Vyāpti; the three doors; upādhi; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Model answer (~250 words)

The Cārvāka holds that anumāna is not a pramāṇa, because vyāpti cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a petitio principii; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred — and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". Upādhi deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that vyāpti is built by anvaya-vyatireka, elimination of suspected upādhis, tarka and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, and that parāmarśa — the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance — means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since prakṛti and puruṣa are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since

injunction and apūrva presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the Tattvasaṅgraha attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for mati and śruta. Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies ultimate validity to perception as well — a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

△ Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant — a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument → survey the schools with distinct reasons → the self-refutation charge → the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- Doctrine: vyāpti, upādhi, petitio principii, anvaya-vyatireka, tarka, parāmarśa, sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa.
- Argument: the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".
- Distinction: rejection of inference as pramāṇa versus rejection of practical inference — flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- Comparison: at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- Criticism: self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.
- Balance: one sentence acknowledging that Advaita and Śūnyavāda partly share the Cārvāka's suspicion, but at a different level.
- Conclusion: name the criterion. "Justified against the strong thesis; the residual logical point survives."

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Thesis -- anumana is not a pramana; vyapti is the target
 3 min : Three doors + upadhi, as numbered steps
 4 min : Cross-school survey: Nyaya (full ladder), Samkhya, Mimamsa, Buddhism, Jainism, Advaita (the partial exception)
 2 min : Self-refutation charge, reconstructed
 2 min : Carvaka's best reply -- the softened certainty-thesis
 1 min : Graded verdict with a named criterion
 Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering only Limb 1 and omitting the candidate's own verdict: loses the entire third limb, worth roughly a third of the marks.
- Giving one generic reason for all schools: shows no school-specific knowledge.
- Writing "Cārvāka says nobody ever infers": factually wrong; the sources record the opposite concession.
- Presenting the self-refutation charge as decisive without the reply: fails the implicit "critically" demand.
- Placing Advaita on the Cārvāka's side without the level-distinction: a serious doctrinal error.
- Drifting into hedonism or the ritual polemic: out of scope, and it costs time.

PYQ 2 — 2019, Q5(c), 10 marks

Exact question

"Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss with an explicit verdict on consistency — a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence, not about whether inference is in fact valid
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading — but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Model answer (~165 words)

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a universal, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential — and self-defeating — or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. △ Three are available. (i) Vitaṇḍā: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty — but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The softened thesis: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield apodictic certainty, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The level-distinction: concede vyāvahārika validity, deny the pāramārthika — though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

△ Verdict: inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be radical or consistent, but not both.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: state the charge as numbered steps → give the replies → deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the vyāpti argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- Doctrine: the exact form of the thesis being tested — "no inference is a pramāṇa" — and its universality.
- Argument: the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- Distinction: pramāṇa-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- Technical terms: vitaṇḍā, vyāvahārika / pāramārthika, pramāṇa.
- Criticism: the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.
- Balance: note that Śūnyavāda and Advaita escape the charge precisely because they do have a level-distinction.
- Conclusion: a two-sided verdict, not a flat "yes" or "no". The one-line formula is worth memorising.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : State the thesis precisely, as a universal
 2 min : The charge, in four numbered steps + the other-minds point
 2 min : Replies (i), (ii), (iii), each with one line of assessment
 1 min : Note that Sunyavada/Advaita escape via level-distinction
 1 min : Graded verdict -- radical or consistent, not both
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Spending the answer re-narrating the three doors: answers the 2025 question, not this one.
- Concluding "yes, consistent" without engaging the charge: the question is built on the charge.

- Concluding "no, inconsistent" and stopping: omits the replies, so the discussion is one-sided.
- Attributing the level-distinction to Cārvāka as historical doctrine: factually wrong; label it a repair.
- Omitting that the Cārvāka must argue, and arguing presupposes other minds: loses the sharpest form of the objection.

PYQ 3 — 2019, Q6(c), 15 marks

Exact question

"What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis — application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise, not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty — it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as vyāpti; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; petitio principii; upādhi; one line of self-critical balance

Model answer (≈250 words)

The Cārvāka objection is not that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the major premise, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as vyāpti does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about this particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal — petitio principii, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an argument in a circle: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. Upādhi deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

△ Verdict: the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction — though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: disclaim the attack on validity → identify the major premise as vyāpti → run the three doors on this premise → petitio principii → upādhi → verdict.
- Doctrine: vyāpti, sāmānya / class-character, upādhi, petitio principii.
- Argument: the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- Distinction: validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- Technical terms: major premise as vyāpti; sādhyā and hetu; anumāna and pramāṇa.
- Comparison: one line noting that Nyāya would answer with anvaya-vyatireka, tarka and parāmarśa.
- Balance: one self-critical line on the Cārvāka's own position.
- Conclusion: "valid but epistemically empty" is the precise register the examiner rewards.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : "The objection is not to validity" -- say it first
 2 min : Identify "All men are mortal" as the vyapti
 5 min : Three doors applied to that premise; add the class-character reply
 2 min : Petitio principii; induction and deduction cure each other
 2 min : Upadhi -- is man-ness really the relevant ground?
 1 min : One line of Nyaya rejoinder + verdict
 Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism invalid: the single most penalised error in this question.
- Reciting the smoke-and-fire example without transferring the argument to "All men are mortal": the examiner set a Western syllogism precisely to test transfer.
- Omitting petitio principii: loses Sharma's crisp formulation of the deductive half.
- Omitting upādhi: loses the deepest layer of the critique.
- Ending without any self-critical line: the "justify with arguments" demand implies evaluation.

PYQ 4 — 2020, Q6(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Critically evaluate and examine — two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice, once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let ākāśa consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong — and as vulnerable — as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to-ākāśa inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Model answer (~255 words)

Ākāśa. ✓ Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four — earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: ākāśa "is not perceived but inferred" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument — sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore ākāśa exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a pramāṇa, that route is closed.

△ Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that ākāśa is a theoretical posit, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements as substances, so he cannot refuse the substance–quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air — a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. ✓ Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: dehātmavāda makes the self the living body — caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; karma and adṛṣṭa are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

△ Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates. Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production — "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

△ Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice — and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- Doctrine: four bhūtas; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; dehātmavāda; adṛṣṭa.
- Argument: the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- Distinction: rejecting ākāśa as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- Technical terms: ākāśa, bhūta, adṛṣṭa, caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ, pramāṇa.
- Criticism: at least two — the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.
- Comparison: one line on Vaiśeṣika's nine dravyas or Jainism's six, to make the four-element claim vivid.
- Conclusion: name the unifying thesis — one argument, two applications.

Compact skeleton and timing

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1 min : Frame -- ontology is epistemology's shadow
3 min : Akāśa: four vs five elements; the Vaisesika inference; its refusal
2 min : Critical evaluation of the akasa half, including the cost
3 min : Transmigration: the four requirements, each cut
3 min : Examination -- strengths and the three weaknesses
1 min : Unifying verdict
Total : 13 minutes
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Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "five elements": the single most examined factual trap in this syllabus item.
- Treating the two halves as unrelated: misses the thesis that unifies the answer.
- Pure exposition with no evaluation: the directive is "critically evaluate"; expect heavy penalty.
- Saying Cārvāka "does not know of" ākāśa: he knows the argument and refuses it.
- Omitting adṛṣṭa by name: it is the perfect test case, since its name means "the unseen".
- Confusing the Cārvāka's denial of transmigration with the Buddhist denial of a transmigrating self: entirely different positions; Buddhism accepts rebirth.

PYQ 5 — 2020, Q7(c), 15 marks

Exact question

"Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Explain the differences — a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality: what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits — Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	Pramāṇas; the definition of sat; four bhūtas versus six dravyas; ākāśa; soul and consciousness; anekāntavāda and syādvāda; karma; liberation; and the shared nāstika ground

Model answer (~255 words)

Epistemic root. ✓ Cārvāka admits one pramāṇa, pratyakṣa. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge — mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala — and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. ✓ For Jainism, sat is utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya — origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as dravya while its paryāyas change. Cārvāka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. ✓ Four bhūtas for Cārvāka; six dravyas for Jainism — jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla. Ākāśa is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. ✓ Cārvāka: no jīva; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many jīvas, with consciousness their inseparable essence — expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. ✓ Jainism's anekāntavāda, with nayavāda and syādvāda, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Karma and liberation. ✓ Jainism: karma as subtle matter adhering to the jīva, bhāva-bandha and dravya-bandha, with mokṣa through the three jewels and kevala-jñāna. Cārvāka: no karma, and maraṇam eva apavargaḥ.

⚠ Verdict. Their agreement is instructive: both are nāstika, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances — which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- Doctrine: utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya; six dravyas; guṇa and paryāya; anekānta, naya, syādvāda; four bhūtas.
- Argument: show that the metaphysical divergence is generated by the epistemic divergence.
- Distinction: Jaina dharma and adharma are media of motion and rest, not merit and demerit — a classic trap.
- Technical terms: sat, dravya, jīva, pudgala, bhūta, kevala-jñāna, bhāva-bandha and dravya-bandha.
- Comparison: at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.

- Balance: the shared nāstika, realist and non-theistic ground must appear, or the answer reads as caricature.
- Conclusion: the standpoint thesis, and the change-and-persistence point.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Frame -- epistemic root generates the metaphysical divergence
 2 min : Pramanas: one vs fivefold knowledge
 2 min : Definition of the real: utpada-vyaya-dhrauvya vs elemental permanence
 2 min : Constituents: 4 bhutas vs 6 dravyas; akasa
 2 min : Soul and consciousness: emergent by-product vs inseparable essence
 2 min : Anekantavada, nayavada, syadvada vs single standpoint
 1 min : Karma and liberation
 1 min : Shared ground + unifying verdict
 Total : 13 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering "materialism versus spirituality": a slogan, not a comparison; heavily penalised at 15 marks.
- Writing two separate accounts with no cross-reference: the directive is "differences", which requires axes.
- Translating Jaina dharma and adharma as virtue and vice: a factual error the examiner watches for.
- Omitting ākāśa: it is the sharpest single contrast available.
- Saying Jainism holds consciousness to be produced: it is the soul's inseparable essence, and Jain sources deny the Cārvāka view by name.
- Omitting the shared ground: loses the evaluative sophistication that lifts the answer.

PYQ 6 — 2021, Q5(e), 10 marks

Exact question

"Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Comment on the bearing — the examiner wants the derivation, not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the vyāpti argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Model answer (≈165 words)

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a pramāṇa: anumāna fails because vyāpti is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (petitio principii), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); śabda fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "follows from" this epistemological conclusion.

The bearing is systematic. The bridging principle — ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted pramāṇas — is then applied without exception. Ākāśa falls, being inferred from sound. Ātman falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. Īśvara falls, being reached only by design-inference while svabhāva discharges the explanatory work. Karma, adṛṣṭa, rebirth, svarga and mokṣa fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with śabda, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

△ Comment: the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: epistemology compressed into one paragraph → the bridging principle → the derivation, entity by entity → one evaluative line.
- Doctrine: pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda; the bridging principle; svabhāvavāda.
- Argument: the derivation must read as a consequence, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".
- Distinction: the bridging principle is a presupposition, not a theorem — an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- Technical terms: ākāśa, ātman, Īśvara, karma, adṛṣṭa, svarga, mokṣa, śabda.
- Comparison: if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep karma and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.
- Conclusion: the vulnerability is located in the premise, not in the denials.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Thesis -- ontology is the shadow of epistemology
 2 min : Compressed anti-inference and anti-sabda argument
 1 min : Name the bridging principle AS a presupposition
 2 min : Derive: akasa, atman, isvara, karma/adṛṣṭa, rebirth, svarga, moksa, Veda, ritual
 1 min : Evaluative comment
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Two disconnected paragraphs, epistemology then denials: the word "bearing" is precisely what such an answer misses.
- Listing entities without connectives: reads as a catalogue, not a derivation.
- Spending five of seven minutes on vyāpti: wrong allocation for a 10-marker on the bearing.
- Omitting adṛṣṭa: the best single illustration of the principle.
- No evaluative line: "comment" invites one.

PYQ 7 — 2024, Q5(a), 10 marks

Exact question

"Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications — a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference

Element	Requirement
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit, not in method; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Model answer (≈165 words)

△ Yes in spirit, no in method.

The case for. ✓ The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called positivism, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, karma and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "meaningless".

The case against. △ Positivism is built on inference — science is systematised inference — which Cārvāka denies pramāṇa-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

△ Verdict: an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. Radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: verdict first → case for → case against → refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- Doctrine: the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason — this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- Argument: the inference divergence must be identified as the decisive disanalogy, not listed among equals.
- Distinction: spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- Technical terms: pratyakṣa, anumāna, pramāṇa, svabhāvavāda, verification, unobservables.
- Comparison: at least one named Western reference point — Comte or Ayer — used precisely.
- Balance: note the "meaningless" register as genuine support for the label, and then explain why it still does not settle the matter.
- Conclusion: offer the better label rather than merely refusing the given one.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Verdict -- positivistic in spirit, not in method
 2 min : For: textbook's own label; empiricist criterion; anti-metaphysics; anti-authority; naturalistic ethics; "meaningless" register
 2 min : Against: inference; unobservables; no constructive programme; no formal tools; no Comtean content
 1 min : Refined label + the anti-inferential paradox
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- A flat "yes": ignores the decisive divergence over inference.
- A flat "no": ignores that the standard textbook applies the label itself.
- Refusing all cross-cultural comparison: evades the question rather than answering it.

- Long exposition of Comte or Ayer: the question is about Cārvāka.
- Not offering an alternative label: loses the constructive half of the "justifications" demand.

PYQ 8 — 2024, Q6(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Differentiate — sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of ātman can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in karma, rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	Dehātmavāda with its formula; the five skandhas; santāna; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that rūpa is itself a skandha; the divergent aftermaths

Model answer (≈345 words)

Both schools reject the ātman of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. ✓ The doctrine is dehātmavāda — caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The ground is epistemological: perception alone is a pramāṇa, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an emergent by-product of the organised elements — as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; karma, rebirth, svarga and mokṣa all lapse, and maraṇam eva apavargaḥ.

Buddhism: dissolution. ✓ Anātman denies not the transcendence but the substantiality of the self. The person is analysed into five skandhas — rūpa, vedanā, saṃjñā, saṃskāra, vijñāna — with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The ground is ontological and soteriological: pratīyasamutpāda and kṣaṇikavāda leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by santāna, the causal stream, with pratisandhāna and, in Yogācāra, ālaya-vijñāna bearing bījas. Hence karma and rebirth survive without a self, and nirvāṇa remains the goal.

△ The four differentiating theses. (i) Targets differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind — and since rūpa is itself one of the skandhas, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self by name. (ii) Grounds differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) Aftermaths differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) Prices differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

△ Verdict: Cārvāka denies the self's transcendence while retaining its substantiality; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its moral continuity.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: the two positions stated compactly → four explicit differentiating theses → a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.

- Doctrine: dehātmavāda with the Sanskrit formula; the five skandhas named in order; santāna; prāṭītyasamutpāda and kṣaṇikavāda.
- Argument: the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- Distinction: transcendence versus substantiality — this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- Technical terms: caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ, anātman / nairātmyavāda, pudgala-nairātmya, ālaya-vijñāna, bīja.
- Criticism: the point that rūpa is itself a skandha, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly — very few candidates make it.
- Comparison: the internal foils, Puggalavāda in Buddhism and Sadānanda's four materialisms in Cārvāka, are worth one sentence each at 20 marks.
- Conclusion: the relocation-versus-dissolution formula, stated crisply.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Frame -- both reject atman, but not in the same way
 5 min : Carvaka: dehatmavada, epistemic ground, first-person argument, emergence analogies, mortality consequence
 5 min : Buddhism: five skandhas, chariot, ontological + soteriological ground, santana / pratisandhana / alaya-vijnana
 4 min : The four differentiating theses, stated as theses
 1 min : Internal foils -- Puggalavada; Sadananda's four materialisms
 1 min : Verdict -- relocation vs dissolution
 Total : 18 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "both deny the soul" and then describing each separately: the exact error this question was designed to catch.
- Saying Buddhism reduces the person to the body: false; rūpa is one of five skandhas and is itself denied selfhood.
- Saying Cārvāka denies the self altogether: he denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one.
- Saying Cārvāka denies consciousness: he denies its immaterial bearer.
- Omitting santāna, or smuggling a soul into it: the standard Buddhist device must appear.
- Missing the aftermath asymmetry: Cārvāka ends the moral story; Buddhism continues it without an owner.
- Omitting the Sanskrit formula: at 20 marks the examiner expects the technical vocabulary.

PYQ 9 — 2025, Q5(a), 10 marks

Exact question

"Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Explain the ground — a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing vyāpti
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that vyāpti, without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits
Non-negotiables	Vyāpti defined; the three doors; upādhi; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Model answer (~165 words)

✓ The ground is the impossibility of establishing vyāpti. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived sādhyā, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance — "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a pramāṇa, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a petitio principii, since the further inference needs its own vyāpti.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Upādhi completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

△ Hence truth is "only an accident, and a separable one" in inference — not the guaranteed character a pramāṇa requires.

What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: define vyāpti → three doors → upādhi → the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- Doctrine: vyāpti, liṅga and sādhyā, upādhi, petitio principii.
- Argument: the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- Distinction: rejection as pramāṇa versus everyday expectation — one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- Technical terms: at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- Comparison: at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.
- Conclusion: the "accident and separable" formulation is the sharpest available and should close the answer.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Define vyapti and state why inference needs it
 3 min : The three doors, one short paragraph each
 2 min : Upadhi -- the wet-fuel case; hidden conditions
 1 min : Conclusion -- truth is accidental and separable in inference
 Total : 7 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing about Cārvāka metaphysics or ethics: out of scope for a tightly focused 10-marker.
- Giving only "we cannot observe all cases" and stopping: one door out of three.
- Omitting upādhi: the deepest layer of the ground is missing.
- Writing that Cārvāka rejects all reasoning whatsoever: contradicted by the sources.
- Spending half the answer on the Nyāya reply: the question asks for the ground, not the debate.

Part II — 32 Hard UPSC-Style MCQs

Key discipline: Questions 1–32 follow the correct-answer sequence A, B, C, D repeated exactly eight times, with no deviation. Each question has four plausible options, a detailed explanation, and a one-line trap note. Coverage spans all nine subtopics of the learning session.

MCQ 1 — The three names

Which set correctly pairs each name of the school with the sense recorded in the standard textbooks?

- A. Cārvāka — from carv, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from cāru-vāk, "sweet-worded"; Lokāyata — lokāyata-mata, "the view of the common people"; Bārhaspatya — "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose Sūtra is lost.
- B. Cārvāka — "the four-element theorist"; Lokāyata — "the world-renouncer"; Bārhaspatya — a disciple of Jayarāṣi.
- C. Cārvāka — a Buddhist sect of the Majjhima Nikāya; Lokāyata — the Jaina name for materialism; Bārhaspatya — a Mīmāṃsā sub-school.
- D. Cārvāka — "the sceptic"; Lokāyata — "the ritualist"; Bārhaspatya — the author of the Tattvopaplavasīṃha.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta record both etymologies of "Cārvāka" — the name of a sage, or a descriptive name from carv ("eat, chew") or cāru-vāk ("nice word") — and gloss lokāyatamata as "the view of common people". Sharma records Bṛhaspati as "a heretical teacher ... regarded as the traditional founder of this school", whose Sūtra "has unfortunately perished". D misattributes the Tattvopaplavasīṃha, which is Jayarāṣi's.

 *Trap: Lokāyata means "of the common people", not "world-renouncing" — the school is emphatically this-worldly.*

MCQ 2 — The exact sense of nāstika

In Sanskrit philosophical literature, in what sense or senses is Cārvāka nāstika?

- A. Only in the modern vernacular sense of "atheist", since it denies God.
- B. In both classical senses — it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are nāstika on the first criterion but would count as āstika on the second.
- C. In neither sense, since nāstika applies only to schools that deny the external world.
- D. Only in the second sense, since Cārvāka accepts Vedic authority while rejecting the afterlife.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set this out exactly: "'Āstika' means 'one who believes in the authority of the Vedas' or 'one who believes in life after death'... The six orthodox schools are 'āstika', and the Cārvāka is 'nāstika' in both the senses." They add that in the second sense "even the Jaina and Bauddha schools are 'āstika', as they believe in life after death." A adopts the modern vernacular sense, which fails because Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet āstika. D reverses the school's most famous rejection.

 *Trap: nāstika is primarily about Vedic authority, not about God.*

MCQ 3 — The source situation

Which statement best describes the textual situation of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. The complete Bṛhaspati-sūtra survives with three commentaries.
- B. Nothing whatever is known of the school, since all sources are hostile.
- C. No systematic primary work survives; the Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost and only about a dozen sūtras and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views in order to refute them, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".
- D. The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha is an independent primary source written by a Cārvāka.

Answer: C

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism... almost every work of the other schools states, for refutation, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma adds that even the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary "seems to be based on such accounts", which disposes of D. B overstates: convergence across independent hostile sources still fixes a doctrinal core.

Trap: the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha is Mādhava's Vedāntic compendium — an opponent's summary, not Cārvāka scripture.

MCQ 4 — Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

What is the correct scholarly use of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa's Tattvopaplavasīmha in a Cārvāka answer?

- A. As the primary text establishing that perception alone is a pramāṇa.
- B. As a Nyāya refutation of Cārvāka epistemology.
- C. As a Mīmāṃsā defence of Vedic authority against the materialists.
- D. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition and as its internal limit-case — since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of perceptual knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta describe the Tattvopaplavasīmha as "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism" whose author "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements", concluding "like an anti-intellectualist pragmatist" that practical life goes on regardless. Sharma records its publication by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940. A is exactly the misuse the option is designed to test; B and C misplace him entirely.

Trap: using Jayarāśi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis — perception alone is a pramāṇa — that defines the school.

MCQ 5 — The pramāṇa ledger

Arranged by the number of independent pramāṇas admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.
- B. Cārvāka 2 · Nyāya 3 · Mīmāṃsā 4 · Advaita 5.
- C. Cārvāka 1 · Nyāya 2 · Sāṃkhya 4 · Advaita 3.
- D. All schools admit exactly three pramāṇas, differing only in their names.

Answer: A

Explanation: This is the standard ledger of classical Indian epistemology: Cārvāka admits perception alone; Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism add inference; Sāṃkhya-Yoga add testimony; Nyāya adds comparison; Prābhākara adds postulation; Bhāṭṭa and Advaita add non-apprehension. Cārvāka sits at the lower bound, which is precisely why every other school must justify its additions against him. B, C and D misplace multiple schools.

Trap: Cārvāka is not an eccentric outlier but the minimum of a shared ledger — say so, and the answer immediately looks structural rather than descriptive.

MCQ 6 — Internal perception and consciousness

An opponent argues: "Internal perception gives immediate knowledge of our mental states, and in these we perceive consciousness, which is nowhere found in external material objects; so there must be an immaterial substance whose quality consciousness is." How does the Cārvāka respond?

- A. He denies that consciousness exists.
- B. He admits that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity — consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.

- C. He denies internal perception altogether, admitting only the five external senses.
- D. He accepts the argument and admits an immaterial soul while denying its immortality.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the reply verbatim in substance: "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity. As consciousness is perceived to exist in the perceptible living body composed of the material elements, it must be a quality of this body itself." A makes him an eliminativist; C would gut the very reply he needs; D contradicts dehātmavāda.

 *Trap: Cārvāka is a materialist about consciousness, not a denier of it.*

MCQ 7 — Truth as an "accident"

The Cārvāka concedes that people constantly act on inference and that inferences sometimes succeed. What philosophical conclusion does he draw from that concession?

- A. That inference is therefore a pramāṇa in practical matters.
- B. That success proves the underlying vyāpti.
- C. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one" — so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that pramāṇa-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.
- D. That all inferences are false.

Answer: C

Explanation: The formulation is Chatterjee and Datta's: people "act uncritically on the wrong belief that our inference is true"; sometimes inference succeeds and sometimes it errs; therefore truth is "only an accident, and a separable one, that we find only in some inferences." A and B are the very inferences the Cārvāka blocks. D overstates: he never claims all inferences are false, only that truth does not belong to inference as such.

 *Trap: the argument is about the modality of truth's attachment to inference — accidental and separable, not essential and inseparable.*

MCQ 8 — The rejection of śabda

Which reconstruction correctly gives the Cārvāka argument against testimony as an independent pramāṇa?

- A. Words are unreal, therefore what they express is unreal.
- B. Only ṛṣis are reliable, and no ṛṣi is now perceivable.
- C. Scripture is composed by human beings, therefore every scriptural statement is false.
- D. Words heard through the ears are perceived, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" — so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Answer: D

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's argument step for step, and it explains why the Cārvāka can reject śabda as a pramāṇa without rejecting language: sounds are perceived, meanings are not. A is false — words are perceived and real. B invents a condition of reliability the Cārvāka never accepts. C is a non sequitur; the Cārvāka's charge against the Veda is epistemic and sociological, not a general inference from human authorship to falsity.

 *Trap: rejecting testimony as a pramāṇa is not rejecting communication.*

MCQ 9 — Door 1

Why, according to the Cārvāka, can vyāpti not be established by perception?

- A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of all cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".
- B. Because perception is itself invalid, being contradicted by inference in cases such as the apparently flat earth.
- C. Because perception apprehends only universals and never the particulars between which the relation is supposed to hold.
- D. Because vyāpti is a relation between words rather than between things, and words are not perceived.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta state the argument in exactly these terms: the major premise "can be established only if we have a knowledge of all cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible." B is Sharma's counter-attack against the Cārvāka, not the Cārvāka's own reasoning — he accepts perception as the one pramāṇa. C inverts the position, and would in any case describe Nyāya's sāmānyalakṣaṇa doctrine rather than Cārvāka's. D confuses the semantic vehicle of the universal with its content; the Cārvāka's objection is evidential, and he elsewhere insists that words heard are perceived.

 *Trap: the gap between the observed set and the universal claimed is a gap of kind, not of degree — no amount of further counting closes it.*

MCQ 10 — The class-character reply

An objector says: granted we cannot perceive all individual smokes, we can perceive the class-characters "smokeness" and "fireness" and the relation between them, and so license the inference. What is the Cārvāka's two-part reply?

- A. That class-characters are perceived only by yogins.
- B. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between all individual cases follows — to infer a particular fire one must know it is inseparably related to the particular smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."
- C. That class-characters do not exist, since only Nyāya posits universals.
- D. That the relation between class-characters is established by testimony.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give both limbs: the universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference, and the class-character is itself not perceptually knowable while all instances are not perceived. A invents a doctrine of yogic perception the Cārvāka would reject outright. C states a stronger ontological thesis than the reply requires. D contradicts the rejection of śabda.

 *Trap: the reply is two-part; giving only one limb halves the argument.*

MCQ 11 — Door 2 and the deduction–induction pair

Sharma summarises the Cārvāka case against inference with the line "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle." What exactly does each half assert?

- A. That induction is deductive and deduction is inductive.
- B. That both are valid but useless.
- C. That deduction is a petitio principii, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and induction, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" — so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.

D. That deduction is invalid in form and induction is invalid in matter.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sharma states both halves in these terms, adding the Cārvāka gibe that "the logicians ... find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference." D is wrong on the first half: the Cārvāka concedes deductive validity and attacks the grounding of the premise. A is incoherent; B misses the epistemic point.

 *Trap: the dilemma is a trap because each horn's cure is the other horn's wound.*

MCQ 12 — Door 3's second bolt

Besides the circularity of grounding inference in testimony whose own validity is inferred, what second objection does the Cārvāka raise against basing vyāpti on testimony?

A. That testimony is always given in Sanskrit, which most people do not understand.

B. That testimony belongs to the āstika schools alone.

C. That testimony is a species of perception and therefore adds nothing.

D. That "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself" — which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma both record this reductio. It is independent of the circularity objection and is regularly omitted by candidates, which is exactly why it is worth carrying. A is irrelevant; B is false of Jainism and Buddhism, which reject Vedic authority but use testimony; C confuses the perception of sounds with the acceptance of content.

 *Trap: two bolts on Door 3 — circularity and the first-person point.*

MCQ 13 — The upādhi example

In the standard textbook illustration of upādhi, which inference goes wrong, and why?

A. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives fire and infers smoke; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (upādhi) of wetness of fuel, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.

B. A man perceives smoke and infers fire; he errs because smoke may arise without fire.

C. A man perceives a rope and infers a snake; he errs because of defective light.

D. A man perceives a gavaya and infers a cow; he errs because similarity is not identity.

Answer: A

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's example verbatim in substance, and note the direction: the defective inference runs from fire to smoke, not from smoke to fire. Sharma and the authored knowledge file confirm the same case. B reverses the direction and states a claim the Cārvāka does not make in this illustration; C is the standard Advaita example of error; D concerns upamāna.

 *Trap: candidates routinely reverse this example. The upādhi case is fire → smoke, defeated by wet fuel; a red-hot iron ball is fire without smoke.*

MCQ 14 — The causal escape

A logician proposes: "We can ground the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a causal relation between them." How does the Cārvāka answer?

A. That causal relations are established by scripture.

- B. That "a causal relation, being only a kind of invariable relation, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" — so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived upādhi is operating.
- C. That causation is a category of the understanding imposed by the mind.
- D. That causal relations hold only between material elements and therefore cannot ground any inference.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give exactly this reply, and add the crucial second step about upādhi: mere repeated co-occurrence proves nothing until unconditionality is secured, and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden". A contradicts the rejection of śabda; C imports Kant; D is not the Cārvāka's argument.

 *Trap: the causal move is not an escape — a causal relation is a species of the invariable relation under attack.*

MCQ 15 — The Socrates syllogism

According to the Cārvāka, what precisely is wrong with "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal"?

- A. The middle term is undistributed, making the syllogism formally invalid.
- B. Socrates is not perceived by the speaker, so no proposition about him can be entertained.
- C. Nothing in its form — but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as vyāpti, and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (petitio principii or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.
- D. The conclusion concerns a future event, and no statement about the future can be meaningful.

Answer: C

Explanation: The Cārvāka grants formal validity and attacks the grounding of the universal; Sharma adds that the conclusion is "already contained in the major premise". A misdescribes a valid Barbara syllogism. B would abolish reference through testimony altogether, which even the Cārvāka does not do, since words are perceived. D imports a verificationist thesis about future-tensed statements that no Cārvāka source advances in this form.

 *Trap: never write that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism invalid.*

MCQ 16 — The self-refutation charge

Which formulation states the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka most precisely?

- A. That the Cārvāka contradicts scripture, which is self-refuting for any Indian school.
- B. That the Cārvāka's hedonism contradicts his materialism.
- C. That the Cārvāka's acceptance of perception contradicts his acceptance of the four elements.
- D. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a universal proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.

Answer: D

Explanation: Sharma states the charge at length, concluding that "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy." A confuses heterodoxy with incoherence. B and C name tensions that are not the self-refutation charge — and C is not a tension at all, since the four elements are perceptible.

 *Trap: the sharpest form of the charge is the other-minds point, and it is the one most often omitted.*

MCQ 17 — Anvaya and vyatireka

In the Nyāya construction of vyāpti, what do anvaya and vyatireka contribute, and why is the pair stronger than mere counting?

- A. Anvaya is agreement in presence — wherever the hetu, there the sādhyā; vyatireka is agreement in absence — where the sādhyā is absent, the hetu is absent. Together they make bhūyodarśana a structured search for counter-instances rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find hetu-without-sādhyā has a warrant that a mere count does not.
- B. Anvaya is the major premise and vyatireka the minor premise of the five-membered syllogism.
- C. Anvaya is perception and vyatireka is inference.
- D. Anvaya is the elimination of upādhis and vyatireka is hypothetical reasoning.

Answer: A

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists repeated observation (bhūyodarśana), supportive reasoning (tarka) and elimination of upādhi as the means of establishing vyāpti, and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence is the disciplined form the observation takes. B misdescribes the pañcāvayava structure; C and D misassign the terms — upādhi-elimination and tarka are distinct stages.

 *Trap: the Nyāya answer to Cārvāka is negative-case testing, not "we have seen many cases".*

MCQ 18 — Tarka

What is tarka, and what is its status in Nyāya?

- A. A fifth pramāṇa alongside perception, inference, comparison and testimony.
- B. Not a pramāṇa at all but a pramāṇa-anugrahaka — an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (aniṣṭa-prasaṅga), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of vyāpti.
- C. The extraordinary perception through which a universal is presented in a particular.
- D. The technical name for the fallacy of the undistributed middle.

Answer: B

Explanation: Nyāya expressly refuses tarka independent pramāṇa status while assigning it a decisive doubt-removing role; the authored Nyāya file lists it among the means of establishing vyāpti alongside repeated observation and upādhi-elimination. A promotes it wrongly; C describes sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa; D confuses a supportive method with a formal fallacy.

 *Trap: tarka proves nothing by itself — say so, and the answer sounds like Nyāya rather than like a summary of Nyāya.*

MCQ 19 — Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa

How does Nyāya answer the Cārvāka objection that "smokeness" cannot be perceived because not all smokes are perceived?

- A. By conceding the point and grounding vyāpti in scripture instead.
- B. By denying that universals exist.
- C. Through sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented through any perceived particular — so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.
- D. By arguing that "smokeness" is a mere name with no cognitive content.

Answer: C

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists as a standard trap the claim "that universals are not perceived. Nyāya allows their perception through sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa." A abandons Nyāya's insistence that inference is independent of testimony; B and D are nominalist positions Nyāya explicitly rejects.

 *Trap: the device works only inside Nyāya's realism about universals — say so, and your evaluation looks balanced rather than partisan.*

MCQ 20 — Parāmarśa

Why does the concept of parāmarśa undercut the Cārvāka's description of inference as "a leap in the dark"?

- A. Because parāmarśa is a second perception that confirms the first.
- B. Because parāmarśa is a scriptural warrant for the inference.
- C. Because parāmarśa is the elimination of all upādhis prior to inferring.
- D. Because parāmarśa is the operative cognition (karaṇa) of anumiti — the apprehension of the mark as qualified by its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") — so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.

Answer: D

Explanation: For Nyāya the inferential cognition is generated by parāmarśa, not by a psychological jump from one perception to an absent object. A, B and C misdescribe the concept — respectively as a further perception, a scriptural licence, and a stage of vyāpti-formation.

 *Trap: the memorable contrast — for Cārvāka a jump in the dark, for Nyāya a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.*

MCQ 21 — Four elements, not five

Which statement about Cārvāka cosmology is correct?

- A. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects ākāśa because it is not perceived but only inferred — from sound to an imperceptible substrate — and inference is not a pramāṇa.
- B. Cārvāka admits five elements but denies that they are eternal.
- C. Cārvāka admits ākāśa but denies that sound is its quality.
- D. Cārvāka admits only earth and water, treating fire and air as their modifications.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; it has to be inferred." Sharma states the same. B contradicts Sharma's further point that "the elements are eternal, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution". C and D have no textual basis.

 *Trap: "five elements" is the single most examined factual error in this syllabus item.*

MCQ 22 — Eternity and combination

What is the correct Cārvāka position on the permanence of the elements and of the things composed from them?

- A. Both the elements and their combinations are momentary.
- B. The elements are eternal, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" — so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.
- C. The elements are produced by God and are therefore contingent.

D. The elements are eternal and their combinations are equally eternal, so nothing ever perishes.

Answer: B

Explanation: Sharma states the doctrine exactly, and Chatterjee and Datta supply the biological corollary that living organisms are composed of the four elements, "by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are reduced on death." A imports Buddhist momentariness; C imports a creator the school denies; D contradicts the observed dissolution of bodies.

 *Trap: this is what makes Cārvāka a realist materialism and sharpens its contrast with Buddhist kṣaṇikavāda.*

MCQ 23 — Two analogies, two objections

The betel analogy and the fermentation analogy both support bhūta-caitanya-vāda. What distinct work does each do?

A. Both answer the same objection, that consciousness cannot be perceived.

B. The betel analogy is Nyāya's and the fermentation analogy Cārvāka's.

C. The betel analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients — leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" — may exhibit a property absent from each; the fermentation analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.

D. The betel analogy establishes that consciousness is a colour and the fermentation analogy that it is a power.

Answer: C

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the two cases with exactly this division of labour — compositional emergence and transformational emergence. B misattributes both; indeed the fermentation case appears in the transmitted Bṛhaspati sūtra kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam. A collapses two distinct arguments; D is a category confusion.

 *Trap: present them as two analogies answering two objections, not as one illustration repeated.*

MCQ 24 — Pot, potter and svabhāva

An objector argues that a jar requires not only clay (material cause) but a potter (efficient cause), so the four elements need God as the world's shaper. What is the Cārvāka reply, and what labels does it earn?

A. That the elements are shaped by adṛṣṭa rather than by God.

B. That God exists but is the material rather than the efficient cause.

C. That the analogy fails because jars are perceived and the world is not.

D. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (svabhāva)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" — earning the labels naturalism (svabhāvavāda), mechanism (yadr̥cchāvāda) and, in the textbook's own words, positivism, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the exchange and then supply all three labels in the same passage. A retains adṛṣṭa, which the school explicitly rejects as an unperceived law. B is Vedāntic, not Cārvāka. C is not the reply given, and would concede the design question.

 *Trap: note the internal tension worth flagging in an answer — svabhāvavāda grounds regularity in fixed natures, while yadr̥cchāvāda calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".*

MCQ 25 — The formula of dehātmavāda

What does caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ assert, and what does it not assert?

- A. It asserts that the person is the body qualified by consciousness — that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does not assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.
- B. It asserts that consciousness is a fifth element.
- C. It asserts that the body is an instrument used by the self.
- D. It asserts that the self is the manas rather than the gross body.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta render the Cārvāka position as "this conscious living body (caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā)". B contradicts the four-element doctrine. C is Sharma's objection — that the body is "a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness" — not the Cārvāka thesis. D names one of Sadānanda's four materialist variants recorded in the Vedāntasāra, not the mainstream formula.

 *Trap: every word of the formula is load-bearing; "qualified by consciousness" is what makes a body a self.*

MCQ 26 — The argument from first-person statements

What is the logical force of the Cārvāka appeal to judgements like "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind"?

- A. That such statements are figurative and therefore prove nothing.
- B. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these would be meaningless category mistakes — so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.
- C. That the body is the object of self-knowledge but not its subject.
- D. That the soul possesses bodily attributes by inherence.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we have direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame', 'I am blind'. If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, these would be meaningless." A is the dualist's reply, not the argument. C and D concede the dualist framework the argument is designed to challenge.

 *Trap: the argument shifts the burden; it does not by itself prove materialism, and saying so improves the answer.*

MCQ 27 — Sharma's objection battery

Which pair of objections, taken together, shows that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes only dependence of consciousness on the body rather than production by it?

- A. That consciousness is private, and that the Vedas are authorless.
- B. That animals lack rational consciousness, and that the elements are eternal.
- C. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen without consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation — "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" — so "the body is a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".
- D. That the Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost, and that Jayarāśi attacks perception.

Answer: C

Explanation: Sharma advances precisely this pair, and their joint effect is to sever the inference from constant co-occurrence to causation. A pairs a genuine objection with an irrelevant Mīmāṃsā doctrine. B pairs a weaker

objection with a doctrine that is not an objection at all. D concerns sources, not the mind–body question.

🔗 *Trap: the honest verdict is that both sides argue from the same evidence to different best explanations — say so rather than declaring a winner.*

MCQ 28 — Cārvāka versus Buddhist denial of self

Which statement differentiates the two denials of ātman most precisely?

- A. Cārvāka denies the self on soteriological grounds, Buddhism on epistemological grounds.
- B. Cārvāka accepts rebirth without a soul; Buddhism denies rebirth.
- C. Both deny the self for identical reasons, differing only in vocabulary.
- D. Cārvāka denies the self's transcendence while retaining a substantial bearer — the living body — on epistemic grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies substantiality as such on ontological and soteriological grounds (pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the santāna so that karma, rebirth and nirvāṇa are preserved — and since rūpa is itself one of the five skandhas, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Answer: D

Explanation: The authored Buddhism file states that Cārvāka "denies self beyond body and tends toward materialist reduction" while Buddhism "denies permanent self but does not reduce personhood simply to gross body", concluding that "both reject an eternal ātman, but for very different reasons and with very different moral-metaphysical consequences." A reverses the grounds; B inverts both positions on rebirth; C is the error the 2024 question was set to detect.

🔗 *Trap: the one-line formula — Cārvāka relocates the self, Buddhism dissolves it.*

MCQ 29 — Adṛṣṭa and transmigration

Why is adṛṣṭa the ideal test case for the Cārvāka's epistemic principle, and what does its rejection entail?

- A. Because adṛṣṭa is by definition "the unseen" — an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility — so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.
- B. Because adṛṣṭa is accepted only by the Jainas.
- C. Because adṛṣṭa is a perceptible quality of the soul.
- D. Because adṛṣṭa is another name for svabhāva.

Answer: A

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta name it among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception." B is false — adṛṣṭa is a Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device. C contradicts its definition. D confuses an unseen moral potency with an inherent natural disposition, which is the very substitution the Cārvāka makes against it.

🔗 *Trap: svabhāva is what the Cārvāka puts in place of adṛṣṭa, not a synonym for it.*

MCQ 30 — Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ

What is the correct reading of the transmitted sūtra "death alone is liberation"?

- A. A recommendation of suicide as the highest human end.
- B. A reductio of the very concept of mokṣa: if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since

embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" — so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".

- C. The Jaina doctrine that liberation is attained at the moment of bodily death.
- D. A ritual prescription for the moment of death.

Answer: B

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set out both horns and the residue, adding the decisive clause that no wise man would work for such an end — which by itself refutes A. C attributes a soul the school denies. D restores the ritual efficacy the school rejects.

 *Trap: the verse attacks the coherence of the goal, not the value of life.*

MCQ 31 — Ethics and the two Cārvākas

Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is accurate on the textbooks' own evidence?

- A. All Cārvākas were gross sensualists, and no source suggests otherwise.
- B. Cārvāka accepts dharma and artha while rejecting kāma and mokṣa.
- C. Kāma is the ultimate end and artha only its means, while dharma is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and mokṣa because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish dhūrta (cunning) from suśikṣita (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of daṇḍanīti and vārtā, the report that some regarded the king as God, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.
- D. Cārvāka ethics is deontological, grounding duty in the fixed natures of things.

Answer: C

Explanation: Every clause is from Chatterjee and Datta, who add that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline" and that the dhūrta / suśikṣita distinction "makes it likely that the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type." A ignores that distinction. B inverts the verdict on all four puruṣārthas. D is incompatible with a hedonistic value theory.

 *Trap: dharma is rejected on epistemic grounds — it is a scriptural category — not because pleasure is more agreeable.*

MCQ 32 — The positivism verdict

Which is the most defensible verdict on whether Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic?

- A. Straightforwardly yes, since both admit only observable phenomena.
- B. Straightforwardly no, since positivism is a nineteenth-century European movement and cross-traditional comparison is illegitimate.
- C. Yes, because Comte's law of three stages is anticipated in the Bṛhaspati-sūtra.
- D. Positivistic in spirit — an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" — but not in method, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies pramāṇa-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism.

Answer: D

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta both apply the label and supply the material that qualifies it, since they also record the wholesale denial of inference and compare the Cārvāka view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". A ignores the methodological chasm; B refuses a comparison the tradition of exposition has itself made; C

invents a claim about a lost text.

🔗 *Trap: the decisive paradox — Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route, whereas modern materialism reaches it by a thoroughly inferential one.*

Part III — Remedial MCQs: Category Errors and Textual-Source Uncertainty

These target the errors that cost the most marks in this syllabus item. They fall into two families: category errors (R1–R5), where two philosophically distinct things are treated as one; and textual and source uncertainty (R6–R10), where a doxographical report is treated as primary evidence. Attempt them only after Part II.

Remedial R1 — "Denies the self" versus "denies a transcendental self"

A student writes: "Cārvāka, like Buddhism, denies the self." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka denies the self entirely and Buddhism affirms a permanent self.
- B. Cārvāka denies the transcendental, immaterial self and positively affirms a material one — caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ, the body qualified by consciousness — whereas Buddhism denies substantiality as such, including the body-self, since rūpa is itself one of the five skandhas; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.
- C. Both deny the self identically; the difference is only terminological.
- D. Buddhism denies the self only in the Mahāyāna schools.

Answer: B · Note: this is the exact error the 2024 twenty-marker was set to catch. D is also false: pudgala-nairātmya is affirmed by the early realist schools as well; Mahāyāna adds dharma-nairātmya.

Remedial R2 — "Rejects inference" versus "never infers"

A student writes: "According to Cārvāka nobody ever infers anything, since inference is impossible." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka accepts inference as a pramāṇa in worldly matters and rejects it only in scripture.
- B. Cārvāka rejects perception as well, following Jayarāśi.
- C. Cārvāka denies inference as a pramāṇa, that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one" — and his sharpest target is transcendental inference, which no perception could ever check.
- D. Cārvāka rejects inference only when it is used by Naiyāyikas.

Answer: C · Note: the distinction between pramāṇa-status and everyday expectation is what makes the position discussable at all. A over-corrects by granting pramāṇa-status; B confuses the school with Jayarāśi.

Remedial R3 — Svabhāva versus adṛṣṭa

A student writes: "Cārvāka explains the world's regularity by adṛṣṭa, the inherent unseen power of things." Which correction is required?

- A. Adṛṣṭa is a Cārvāka term meaning the fixed nature of the elements.
- B. Cārvāka accepts adṛṣṭa but denies karma.
- C. Both terms are synonyms in classical Indian philosophy.
- D. Adṛṣṭa is the unseen moral potency of Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name — Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)" among the casualties; what Cārvāka

puts in its place is svabhāva, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.

Answer: D · Note: the two terms are opposites in function — one is a moral unseen, the other a natural disposition. Confusing them destroys the argument of the 2021 question.

Remedial R4 — Upādhi versus incomplete enumeration

A student writes: "The upādhi objection is simply the point that we have not observed enough cases." Which correction is required?

A. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of sample size, curable in principle by further observation; the upādhi objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an unnoticed condition, so that what remains uncertified is the identification of the relevant ground of the relation — Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden and escape notice." This is why Nyāya must introduce tarka rather than merely more observation.

B. Upādhi means a defect in the form of the syllogism.

C. Upādhi applies only to inferences about the future.

D. Upādhi is the Nyāya name for the middle term.

Answer: A · Note: get the standard example's direction right — one who infers smoke from fire errs, because fire is attended with smoke only where the fuel is wet.

Remedial R5 — Naturalism, mechanism and positivism

A student writes: "Cārvāka's svabhāvavāda is a scientific naturalism, and therefore Cārvāka is a positivist." Which correction is required?

A. Svabhāvavāda is a Sāṃkhya doctrine, not a Cārvāka one.

B. Svabhāvavāda is a metaphysical refusal of teleology, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels — naturalism (svabhāvavāda), mechanism (yadṛcchāvāda, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") — and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed natures and calling the world's objects fortuitous.

C. Cārvāka has no explanatory principle at all.

D. Yadṛcchāvāda means "the doctrine of divine will".

Answer: B · Note: three labels, three different claims. Collapsing them into "Cārvāka was scientific" is the commonest way to lose the 2024 question.

Remedial R6 — What survives of the Bṛhaspati-sūtra

A student writes: "As Bṛhaspati says in his Sūtra, earth, water, fire and air are the elements." Which correction is required?

A. The Bṛhaspati-sūtra survives complete and may be quoted directly.

B. The sūtra is genuine but was composed by Cārvāka rather than Bṛhaspati.

C. The Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost; about a dozen sūtras and verses survive only as quotations in other authors' works, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the sūtra quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" — the content of pṛthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.

D. The sūtra is preserved inside the Tattvopaplavasīmha.

Answer: C · Note: the modal caution costs four words and signals scholarly control. D is false: Jayarāśi's work is an independent sceptical treatise, not a recension of Bṛhaspati.

Remedial R7 — The "ghee and debt" verse

A student opens an answer: "The Cārvāka scripture says: let a man live happily and feed on ghee even though he runs in debt." Which correction is required?

- A. The verse is quoted from Vātsyāyana's Kāma-sūtra.
- B. The verse is preserved in the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium — an opponent's summary written for refutation — and is not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a doxographical characterisation of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.
- C. The verse is a Jaina parody with no relation to Cārvāka.
- D. The verse comes from the Sāmaññaphala-sutta.

Answer: B · Note: the authored knowledge file gives the same instruction for the companion line yāvat jīvet sukhaṃ jīvet — a traditional doxographical verse, "not ... a securely locatable quotation from an extant primary Cārvāka text". A is doubly wrong, since Vātsyāyana argues against refusing deferral.

Remedial R8 — Jayarāśi and the standard Cārvāka

A student writes: "Since Jayarāśi shows that perception too is unreliable, the Cārvākas rejected all pramāṇas." Which correction is required?

- A. Jayarāśi was not a Cārvāka at all but a Buddhist.
- B. Jayarāśi accepts the four elements and differs from the standard Cārvāka only on ethics.
- C. Jayarāśi's work is lost and cannot be assessed.
- D. Jayarāśi is described as a Cārvāka "of an extreme type" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" — so his position is the tradition's internal limit-case, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception alone is a pramāṇa, and using Jayarāśi to state it destroys it.

Answer: D · Note: C is refuted by the publication record — the Oriental Institute of Baroda printed the Tattvopaplavasīṃha in 1940, and it is the "single exception" to the loss of the corpus.

Remedial R9 — One Cārvāka or several?

A student writes: "Cārvāka is a single, uniform doctrine identifying the self with the gross body." Which correction is required?

- A. Sadānanda's Vedāntasāra records four materialist schools, identifying the self respectively with the gross body (sthūla śarīra), the senses (indriya), the vital breaths (prāṇa) and the mental organ (manas), all agreeing only in "regarding the soul as a product of matter"; Śāntarakṣita separately reports Kambalāśvatara holding that consciousness arises from the body associated with vital breaths; and the sources also distinguish dhūrta from suśikṣita Cārvākas. "Cārvāka" therefore names a family of positions.
- B. There were exactly two Cārvāka schools, one theistic and one atheistic.
- C. All Cārvākas identified the self with manas.
- D. The plurality is a modern scholarly invention with no textual basis.

Answer: A · Note: this single point simultaneously answers the "crude and undifferentiated" charge and supplies precise, citable internal differentiation.

Remedial R10 — Reading hostile sources responsibly

Which methodological statement should govern the use of doxographical material in a Cārvāka answer?

- A. Hostile sources should be discarded entirely, leaving the school undiscussable.
- B. Hostile sources should be treated as neutral, since doxographers aimed at accuracy.

C. The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha should be preferred to all others because it is the longest summary.

D. Because the sources are refutational, the crude version of any doctrine is the one most likely to have been preserved — Sharma warns that "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted", so an answer should reconstruct the strongest defensible reading and say that it is doing so, while noting that the convergence of independent Buddhist, Advaita, Jaina and Vedāntic accounts on the same doctrinal core is itself evidence for that core.

Answer: D · Note: A is the counsel of despair and is refuted by convergence; B ignores the stated purpose of the texts; C is refuted by Sharma's observation that even that summary "seems to be based on such accounts".

Part IV — Ten Original Solved Mains Questions

Distribution: three 10-markers, four 15-markers, three 20-markers. Each carries demand decoding, a model answer written to the appropriate length, and a top-answer checklist. These are the ten questions set as practice at the close of the learning session.

Original 10-marker 1

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects śabda as an independent pramāṇa, and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Explain then assess — exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Model answer (≈160 words)

✓ The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are perceived, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference — "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" — and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

⚠ Assessment. The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the sound, which is perceived, and the content, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent pramāṇa-status without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable — but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Top-answer checklist

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly — this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an inference.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes inconsistency from impracticality.

Original 10-marker 2

Question: "Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ." Explain the argument compressed in this Cārvāka sūtra and evaluate it. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Explain the compressed argument, then evaluate
Core issue	That the verse is a reductio of mokṣa, not a recommendation of death
Ideal thesis	It is a coherent dilemma against the concept of liberation, though it presupposes that liberation must be defined as the total cessation of suffering

Model answer (~165 words)

✓ The sūtra compresses a dilemma. What could mokṣa mean? If it means the freedom of a soul from bondage to physical existence, it is "absurd because there is no soul" — dehātmavāda has already removed the candidate. If it means the attainment in this life of a state free from all pain, it is "an impossible ideal", since "existence in this body is bound up with pleasure as well as pain". The only state satisfying the definition of complete cessation of suffering is therefore death — and Chatterjee and Datta add the decisive clause that "no wise man would willingly work for that end".

△ Evaluation. The argument is valid and its rhetorical force is considerable: it exposes that mokṣa, defined negatively as the cessation of suffering, has a trivial satisfier. Its weakness is that most schools define liberation positively — as kevala-jñāna, nirvāṇa or the realisation of Brahman — rather than merely as pain's absence, so the dilemma may be attacking a definition its opponents need not accept.

Top-answer checklist

- Both horns of the dilemma stated, each with its reason.
- The clause "no wise man would work for that end" quoted or paraphrased — it kills the suicide misreading.
- Explicit statement that the verse is a reductio of a concept.
- The evaluative counter: liberation is often defined positively by the rival schools.
- One line linking the verse to dehātmavāda, which supplies the first horn.

Original 10-marker 3

Question: Distinguish svabhāvavāda from yadṛcchāvāda in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. (10 marks, ~150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Distinguish then examine consistency — a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if svabhāva governs the behaviour of elements while yadṛcchā governs their initial concurrence; otherwise there is tension

Model answer (~165 words)

✓ Svabhāvavāda is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (svabhāva)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. ✓ Yadr̥cchāvāda is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or fortuitous combination of elements".

△ Examination. There is a real tension. If the elements combine by their fixed natures, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is fortuitous, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: svabhāva explains how each element behaves once in combination, while yadr̥cchā denies that any purpose governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. △ The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Top-answer checklist

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies teleology, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 15-marker 1

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Examine ... with the objections — exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains — though dualism does not close it either

Model answer (~245 words)

✓ The doctrine. Kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. Betel — leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together — establishes compositional emergence. Fermentation — molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment — establishes transformational emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an epiphenomenon or by-product of matter".

△ Objections. (i) The analogies concern public, third-person qualities; consciousness is private — Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists without consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related — so the body may be the instrument of consciousness rather than its cause.

△ Replies and verdict. The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific organisation rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely renames the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes dependence, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Top-answer checklist

- The transmitted sūtra quoted or paraphrased.
- Both analogies, with their distinct functions named.
- The word epiphenomenon used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing dependence from production.

Original 15-marker 2

Question: "The Cārvāka's upādhi objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Critically discuss an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas upādhi is not

Model answer (~250 words)

✓ The enumeration objection. Vyāpti requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

✓ The upādhi objection. Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from fire and err, having failed to notice the upādhi of wetness of fuel, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be unconditional, it is an uncertain ground for inference" — and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden".

△ Why the second is stronger. Enumeration is a defect of quantity: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. Upādhi is a defect of identification: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical — Nyāya answers enumeration with bhūyodarśana and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in tarka and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa to address upādhi, and concedes that only suspected conditions can be eliminated.

△ Counter-consideration and verdict. Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus tarka is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the upādhi point. The claim therefore stands: upādhi is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Top-answer checklist

- Both objections stated accurately, with the upādhi example running fire → smoke.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.
- Tarka correctly described as an auxiliary, not a pramāṇa.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 15-marker 3

Question: Assess whether the dhūrta / suśikṣita distinction rescues Cārvāka ethics from the charge of crude hedonism. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Assess — a verdict on whether a historical distinction discharges a philosophical charge
Core issue	Whether refinement of taste supplies a standard of value or only a regulation of pursuit
Ideal thesis	It rescues Cārvāka from the caricature but not from the philosophical charge

Model answer (~250 words)

✓ The charge. Sharma: "The ethics of the Cārvāka is a crude individual hedonism"; the school fell not through atheism or materialism, which it shares with respected schools, but through "the denial of all human values which make life worth living" — and "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher."

✓ The distinction. Chatterjee and Datta record that a distinction "between the cunning (dhūrta) and cultured (suśikṣita) Cārvākas makes it likely that the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type." The supporting evidence is substantial: cultivation of the sixty-four fine arts; the incorporation of daṇḍanīti and vārttā into Lokāyata; the report that some Cārvākas "regard the king as God", implying faith in society and its head; and Vātsyāyana's Kāma-sūtra, "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism", with its insistence on self-control, urbanity and educated senses, and its argument that refusing to defer "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds".

△ Assessment. The distinction rescues Cārvāka from the caricature: the historical movement was not uniformly gross, and Chatterjee and Datta themselves note that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline." But it does not discharge the philosophical charge. Vātsyāyana's regulation is prudential — it maximises pleasure over a lifetime — and supplies no qualitative ordering of pleasures and no independent account of other-regarding obligation. Moreover he "believes in God and in life after death", so he is a materialist only "in a wider sense".

△ Verdict: Cārvāka's ethics is a complete theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality.

Top-answer checklist

- Sharma's charge quoted in its strongest form, including the "pleasure of the pig".
- All four items of evidence for refinement, not just Vātsyāyana.
- The caveat that Vātsyāyana is not a materialist in the ordinary sense.
- The distinction between prudential regulation and a qualitative standard of value.
- The prudence/morality verdict, which is the answer's thesis.

Original 15-marker 4

Question: How far do the surviving sources permit a fair reconstruction of Cārvāka philosophy? Discuss with reference to the Bṛhaspati-sūtra, the doxographies and the Tattvopaplavasīṃha. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	How far — a calibrated answer, neither "fully" nor "not at all"

Element	Requirement
Core issue	The evidential value of hostile transmission plus a single unrepresentative surviving text
Ideal thesis	Reconstruction is possible for the doctrinal core through convergence, but not for the school's strongest formulations

Model answer (~250 words)

✓ The evidential situation. No systematic primary work survives. The Brhaspati-sūtra is lost, and about a dozen sūtras and verses are quoted by other authors. Chatterjee and Datta: "almost every work of the other schools states, for refutation, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma is blunter: "the weak points in this school are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture" — and he adds that even the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary "seems to be based on such accounts", so it grants no independent access.

✓ The one surviving text. Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa's Tattvopaplavasiṃha (c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940) is the "single exception". But he is a Cārvāka "of an extreme type" who attacks perception itself and refuses even the physical elements, so he cannot testify to the school's defining thesis.

△ How far, then? Three conclusions are defensible. (i) Doctrinal core: reconstructible. Independent Buddhist (Tattvasaṅgraha), Advaita (Vedāntasāra), Jaina (Ṣaḍ-darśana-samuccaya) and Vedāntic (Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha) accounts converge on perceptualism, anti-inferentialism, four elements, no soul and no afterlife — and convergence across hostile and mutually opposed witnesses is genuine evidence. (ii) Strongest formulations: not recoverable. Where a doctrine has a crude and a defensible version, the crude one is what an opponent preserves. (iii) Internal diversity: partly visible. Sadānanda's four materialist schools and the dhūrta / suśikṣita distinction show a family rather than a monolith.

△ Verdict: enough for philosophy, not enough for philology — which is why answers should say "on the standard reconstruction".

Top-answer checklist

- All three source-types treated, as the question specifies.
- The convergence argument, which is what rescues the answer from scepticism.
- Jayarāṣi correctly characterised as unrepresentative.
- The internal-diversity evidence used as a positive finding.
- A calibrated verdict, with the recommended answer-writing formula.

Original 20-marker 1

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Critically evaluate a strong interpretive claim — say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials, false of the affirmations — the four elements, emergence and svabhāva are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Model answer (≈350 words)

✓ The case for the claim. Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "follows from" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Ātman* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Īśvara* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. Karma, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *mokṣa* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *śabda*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

△ Where the claim fails. Three points. (i) The derivation needs a bridging principle — that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *pramāṇas* — which is a presupposition, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal of that gap is a substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains positive theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly four elements, that they are eternal while their combinations perish, that consciousness emerges from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity — none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *pramāṇa*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *svabhāvavāda* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

△ Verdict. The claim is true of the negative half and false of the positive half. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list — which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. △ Criterion named: derivational economy supports the claim, explanatory content refutes it.

Top-answer checklist

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a presupposition.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadṛcchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict — true of the denials, false of the affirmations — with a named criterion.

Original 20-marker 2

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *vyāpti*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Compare then assess success — the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Model answer (≈350 words)

✓ Cārvāka. Vyāpti is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". Upādhi completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

✓ Nyāya. Vyāpti is assembled, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as *anvaya* (co-presence) and *vyatireka* (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected upādhis are identified and the universal restated at the correct level — "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". Tarka — not a *pramāṇa* but a *pramāṇa-anugrāhaka* — assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, *parāmarśa* — the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance — shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

⚠ Assessment. Nyāya succeeds on three counts. Tarka has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. *Parāmarśa* dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy: perception errs — the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc — and is corrected by inference, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

⚠ Yet three concessions remain. Only suspected upādhis can be eliminated. Tarka proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

⚠ Verdict. Nyāya answers the Cārvāka by changing the standard — from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by warrant, Nyāya wins; judged by entailment, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Top-answer checklist

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- Tarka and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names two criteria and delivers a different result under each.

Original 20-marker 3

Question: Compare the conceptions of reality in Cārvāka and Jainism, and assess which better accounts for change and persistence. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Compare then assess on a specified philosophical criterion — change and persistence
Core issue	Whether asserting eternal elements and transient combinations amounts to an account, or merely a juxtaposition
Ideal thesis	Jainism has the superior analysis; Cārvāka has the superior economy; on the stated criterion Jainism wins

Model answer (~355 words)

✓ Epistemic root. Cārvāka admits one *pramāṇa*, perception. Jainism admits fivefold knowledge — *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manahpariyāya*, *kevala* — and hence inference. Every later divergence follows.

✓ The real. For Jainism, sat is utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: origination, decay and persistence together. Every dravya has guṇa (essential qualities) and paryāya (modes); gold persists as substance while bracelet gives way to ring. The apparent contradiction — that one thing is both changing and permanent — is resolved by respect: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya. For Cārvāka, the elements are eternal while "their combinations undergo production and dissolution".

✓ Constituents and souls. Four bhūtas against six dravyas — jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla; ākāśa rejected as inferred against ākāśa accepted as a distinct substance. No jīva against infinitely many, with consciousness their inseparable essence, expressly denying the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

✓ Standpoint, karma, liberation. Jainism's anekāntavāda, with nayavāda and syādvāda, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned; Cārvāka admits a single standpoint. Jaina karma is subtle matter adhering to the jīva (bhāva-bandha and dravya-bandha), with mokṣa through the three jewels and kevala-jñāna; Cārvāka rejects karma and holds maraṇam eva apavargaḥ.

△ Assessment on the stated criterion. Jainism offers an analysis: the substance–mode distinction explains why the same thing can be both persistent and changing, and the standpoint theory explains why one-sided descriptions seem contradictory. Cārvāka offers a juxtaposition: eternal elements, transient combinations, and no account of what makes a combination the same combination through change — which is precisely why his account of personal identity through memory is thin, resting on bodily continuity without an analysis of what continuity consists in.

△ The counterweight. Cārvāka's economy is a genuine virtue. Jainism purchases its explanatory power with six substances, two media of motion and rest, material karma and a sevenfold predication — every one of which is established inferentially, and therefore every one of which the Cārvāka may refuse at the door.

△ Verdict. On the criterion of accounting for change and persistence, Jainism is decisively superior; on the criterion of ontological economy, Cārvāka is. Since the question specifies the first criterion, the verdict goes to Jainism — but the price is the very inference Cārvāka denies. △ Their shared nāstika, realist and non-theistic ground shows how little that classification settles.

Top-answer checklist

- At least seven named axes, each carrying both positions.
- Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya and the guṇa / paryāya distinction stated precisely.
- Jaina dharma and adharma correctly glossed as media of motion and rest.
- The analysis-versus-juxtaposition contrast used as the assessment's pivot.
- The economy counterweight given fairly before the verdict.
- The shared ground noted, and the verdict tied to the specified criterion.

Part V — Philosophy Optional High-Score Answer Protocol (Cārvāka)

1. Open with the derivation, not with a definition

Weak : Carvaka is the materialist school of Indian philosophy.

Strong: Carvaka is the position obtained when a single epistemic restriction -- only what perception presents may be admitted -- is applied without exception; its ontology is that epistemology's shadow.

Term	The definition must distinguish it from
Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda	The weaker claim that perception is merely the primary source
Vyāpti	A mere observed regularity

Term	The definition must distinguish it from
Upādhi	Incomplete enumeration
Dehātmavāda	Buddhist anātman, and eliminativism about consciousness
Svabhāvavāda	Modern scientific naturalism, and adṛṣṭa
Nāstika	"Atheist" in the modern vernacular sense
Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ	A recommendation of death

2. Reconstruct the anti-inference argument as premises

1. Inference claims certainty only if licensed by vyapti.
2. Vyapti cannot be known by perception (all cases never surveyed; class-characters equally unsurveyed).
3. Vyapti cannot be known by inference (petitio principii / regress).
4. Vyapti cannot be known by testimony (its validity is inferred; and otherwise no one could infer by himself).
5. Even observed constancy may conceal an upadhi, and hidden conditions cannot be excluded by perception.
6. Therefore truth is accidental and separable in inference.
7. Therefore anumana is not a pramana.

Then expose the presupposition — that pramāṇa-hood requires indubitability — and note that it is precisely what Nyāya refuses.

3. Sort every objection by its target

THE PREMISE	: is "only perception is a pramana" defensible? (self-refutation; perceptual error; other minds)
THE BRIDGE	: must ontology track epistemology? (the presupposition that reality does not exceed knowledge)
THE AFFIRMATIONS	: do four elements and emergence do their explanatory work? (the explanatory gap; instrument vs cause)
THE CONSEQUENCES	: can ethics survive without karma and moksa? (prudence vs morality; the pleasure of the pig)

Announcing the target in one clause — "this objection attacks the bridge, not the premise" — signals control and saves words.

4. Use Sanskrit as an instrument, not as decoration

- Gloss on first use: vyāpti (invariable concomitance), upādhi (vitiating condition).
- Preserve epistemic distinctions: pratyakṣa, anumāna, śabda, upamāna, arthāpatti, anupalabdhi.
- Preserve the two directions of the upādhi example: fire → smoke, defeated by wet fuel.
- Preserve the transmitted formulae: caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ, kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ, maraṇam eva apavargaḥ.

5. Never conflate these six pairs

VALIDITY	vs	GROUNDING OF THE PREMISE	(Socrates syllogism)
PRAMANA-STATUS	vs	PRACTICAL USABILITY	(2019 consistency)
UNESTABLISHED	vs	UNREAL	(transmigration)
DEPENDENCE	vs	PRODUCTION	(consciousness)
RELOCATION	vs	DISSOLUTION of the self	(2024 comparison)
DOXOGRAPHY	vs	PRIMARY TEXT	(every quotation)

6. Present objection and reply dialectically

OBJECTION -> BEST AVAILABLE REPLY -> RESIDUAL PRESSURE

Objection : The denial of inference is itself inferential.
 Reply : Soften the thesis -- inference never yields apodictic certainty beyond perceptual check.
 Residual : The softened thesis is fallibilism, not a denial of a pramana; the doctrine survives by shrinking.

Steelman the critic before evaluating. Never introduce a weak objection merely to dismiss it.

7. Grade the verdict and name the criterion

Avoid "completely refuted", "totally illogical", "merely hedonistic". Prefer:

- "valid in form but epistemically empty",
- "consistent in derivation, vulnerable in premise",
- "wins on entailment, loses on pramāṇa-status",
- "a complete theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality",
- "critical in function, unsuccessful as a system".

Name the criterion: evidential economy · explanatory adequacy · internal consistency · perceptual redeemability · moral sufficiency · historiographical reliability.

8. Marks-wise architecture

Marks	Working time	Architecture
10	7–8 min	Thesis → three doors → one sharp addition → verdict linking epistemology to the denial asked about
15	12–13 min	Frame with source caution → full argument → the rival's positive case → best reply and its cost → graded verdict
20	17–18 min	Classify → theory of knowledge in full → ontological consequences → the demanded comparison on named axes → two objections with replies → criterion-named verdict

- 10 marks ≈ 150 words. One controlled argument is enough; do not spend half the answer on background.
- 15 marks ≈ 220–260 words. At least one technical distinction and one serious criticism with a reply.
- 20 marks ≈ 320–360 words. A comparison matrix may precede the prose; two objections, or one developed through reply and residual pressure.

9. Avoid generic prose

Do not write:

"Cārvāka was a materialist who believed in enjoying life and rejected religion."

Write:

"Cārvāka rejects dharma not from appetite but from epistemology: virtue and vice are, in the sources' own words, 'distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted' — so the ethics is the last term in a derivation that begins with the refusal of śabda as a pramāṇa."

10. Final twenty-second audit

- Did I answer the directive — explain, examine, differentiate, critically evaluate, discuss?
- Did I show the derivation from epistemology, rather than listing denials?

- Did I reconstruct at least one argument as numbered premises?
- Did I include one source-caution clause?
- Did I give the objection and the reply before evaluating?
- Did I state a graded verdict with a named criterion?
- Did I avoid the two fatal errors — "five elements", and "Cārvāka and Buddhism deny the self in the same way"?

Part VI — Final Rapid Revision Matrix

Doctrine / issue	Cārvāka position	Key term or formula	Central objection	Best reply	Likely question form
Sole pramāṇa	Perception alone	Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda	Self-refutation; perception errs	Soften to a certainty-thesis	Ground for rejecting inference
Internal perception	Admitted; consciousness is perceived	Mānasa-pratyakṣa	Then an immaterial bearer is needed	Consciousness is a bodily state, not a substance's quality	Self and consciousness
Rejection of anumāna	Not a pramāṇa	Vyāpti unobtainable	Nyāya's ladder	Practical inference is conceded, transcendental denied	2018, 2019, 2025
Door 1	All cases never surveyed	Past, present, future	Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa	Class-characters equally unsurveyed	2025
Door 2	Petitio principii / regress	Deduction circular, induction unwarranted	Tarka removes doubt	Tarka is not a pramāṇa	2019 Socrates
Door 3	Testimony's validity is inferred	"No one could infer anything by himself"	Social life needs testimony	Pragmatic reliance ≠ pramāṇa-status	Śabda questions
Upādhi	Hidden conditions defeat universals	Wet fuel; fire → smoke	Nyāya eliminates suspected upādhis	Only suspected ones can be eliminated	15-mark inference questions
Self-refutation	The charge	"The denial is itself a universal"	Sharma: "sheer nonsense and no system"	Vitaṇḍā / softened thesis / level-distinction	2019 Q5(c)
Four elements	Earth, water, fire, air	prthivyāptejovāyurit i tattvāni	Sound needs a substrate	Naturalise sound into air	2020 Q6(b)
Ākāśa	Rejected — inferred, not perceived	The Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference	Qualities need substrates	Imperceptible substrates are unnecessary multiplication	2020 Q6(b)
Eternity	Elements eternal, combinations transient	Realist materialism	Then what unifies a combination?	Organisation, not substance	Metaphysics questions
Consciousness	Emergent by-product	kiṇvātibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam	Explanatory gap; privacy	The soul-hypothesis renames the gap	Self and consciousness
Betel analogy	Compositional emergence	Leaf + lime + nut → red	Public quality, not subjectivity	Dualism explains no better	15-mark emergence question
Fermentation analogy	Transformational emergence	Guḍa → intoxicant	Same objection	Same reply	Same

Doctrine / issue	Cārvāka position	Key term or formula	Central objection	Best reply	Likely question form
Self	The living body	caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ	Swoon, dream, privacy, subject-object	Organisation-dependence; instrument needs a user	2024 Q6(a)
First-person argument	Bodily predicates attach to "I"	"I am fat / lame / blind"	Figurative reading	Figurative reading is theory-driven	2024 Q6(a)
Versus Buddhism	Relocation vs dissolution	Rūpa is itself a skandha	Both "deny the self"	They deny different things	2024 Q6(a)
Memory	Bodily-psychological continuity	—	Requires a persisting subject	Continuity of the organism	Personal identity
God	Rejected	Svabhāvavāda; pot and potter	The world looks designed	"No proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"	2021; Paper II crossover
Adṛṣṭa	Rejected by name	"The unseen"	Moral order collapses	Prudence and social consequence suffice	2021 Q5(e)
Transmigration	Rejected	Four requirements each cut	Dependence ≠ production; non-existence equally undemonstrable	The burden lies on the positer	2020 Q6(b)
Heaven and hell	"Inventions of the priests"	Svarga rests on an unproved afterlife	Sociological, not philosophical	The epistemic charge is prior	Ritual questions
Mokṣa	Rejected	maraṇam eva apavargaḥ	Read as recommending death	It is a reductio of the concept	10-mark ethics
Veda and ritual	No authority; priestcraft	Śrāddha, upstairs, jyotiṣṭoma	Mere abuse	Jyotiṣṭoma is an argument from revealed preference	Ritual questions
Puruṣārthas	Kāma the end, artha the means	kāma evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ	Crude hedonism	Dhūrta / suśikṣita; Vātsyāyana	Ethics questions
Refined hedonism	Real historical strand	64 arts; daṇḍanīti; vārtā; king-as-God	Vātsyāyana is not a materialist proper	He is one "in a wider sense"	15-mark ethics
Versus Jainism	4 bhūtas vs 6 dravyas	utpāda-vyaya-dhruva; anekānta	"Materialism vs spirituality" is a slogan	Run the axes	2020 Q7(c)
Positivism	In spirit, not in method	Textbook applies the label itself	Positivism runs on inference	Prefer "radical empiricism"	2024 Q5(a)
Sources	Bṛhaspati-sūtra lost	~12 sūtras quoted by others	Caricature	Convergence across hostile witnesses	Any question, one clause
Jayarāśi	Extreme sceptic, c. 8th c. CE	Tattvopaplavasimhā, Baroda 1940	Used to state the school's epistemology	He attacks perception too	Source questions
Historical value	The touchstone of every system	Chatterjee-Datta vs Sharma	"Died in serious thought"	Failed as a system, succeeded as a challenge	Concluding paragraphs

Last-minute memory spine

SPINE : ONE pramana . FOUR elements . TWO purusarthas . ZERO transcendents
DOORS : perception (all cases) . inference (petitio) . testimony (2 bolts)
UPADHI : fire -> smoke, defeated by WET FUEL; hidden conditions always possible
ACCIDENT : "truth is only an accident, and a separable one" -- the key line
NYAYA : anvaya-vyatireka . upadhi-elimination . TARKA (auxiliary) .
samanyalaksana . paramarsa (no leap) . WARRANT not omniscience
ELEMENTS : prthivi ap tejas vayu -- NO AKASA (inferred from sound)
eternal elements, transient combinations
EMERGENCE : BETEL (compositional) . FERMENTATION (transformational)
gap: public qualities vs private consciousness
SELF : caitanya-visistah kayah purusah . "I am fat / lame / blind"
CARVAKA RELOCATES . BUDDHISM DISSOLVES . rupa is itself a skandha
DENIALS : akasa . atman . isvara . karma . adrsta . rebirth . svarga .
naraka . moksa . Veda . ritual -- ALL BY ONE CUT
REDUCTIONS : sraddha and the traveller . food downstairs . jyotistoma and
"why not their own old parents" (revealed preference)
ETHICS : kama end, artha means; dharma = scriptural, hence rejected
DHURTA vs SUSIKSITA . 64 arts . dandaniti + varta . king-as-God
Vatsyayana: defer, or you would never sow a crop
SOURCES : Brhaspati-sutra LOST . ~12 sutras quoted . Sarva-darsana-sangraha
is an OPPONENT . Jayarasi is the LIMIT-CASE, not the standard
VERDICTS : consistent OR radical, not both . dependence not production .
prudence complete, morality incomplete . positivistic in spirit
not in method . the TOUCHSTONE of Indian philosophy

End of the premium solved-PYQ and practice workbook.